

VERIQO Evidence Constitution

Status: FROZEN as of MIP-001 W0 (Architecture Freeze) **Executable form:** `pkg/constitution` — every article below has a machine-checkable representation. MIP-001 §4 requires this: *"These shall become executable policy tests, not merely documentation."*

0. What this document is

Thirty invariants that bind every VERIQO subsystem. They are not aspirations and not style guidance. An article is satisfied only when a check in `pkg/constitution` can evaluate a concrete artifact against it and return a determinate verdict.

Three verdicts exist, and the third is load-bearing:

Verdict	Meaning
SATISFIED	The article was checked against this input and holds.
VIOLATED	The article was checked and does not hold.
NOT_EVALUABLE	The input does not carry what the article needs to be judged. Never read as satisfied.

`NOT_EVALUABLE` exists because the alternative — treating an unanswerable question as a pass — is precisely the failure mode this constitution is written to prevent. It is the constitutional analogue of the verifier's `SKIP`.

1. The articles

Group A — Evidence and truth

Article 1 — No Naked Facts. No finding may exist without evidence lineage. A finding that cites no evidence, or cites evidence with no traceable lineage, is not a finding.

Article 2 — No Truth by Acquisition. Acquiring an artifact establishes that it was acquired. It does not establish that its contents are true. `ACQUIRED ≠ TRUE`.

Article 3 — No Corroboration by Duplication. Two artifacts sharing a root origin, provider pipeline, sensor, collector, or organizational control are **one** source for corroboration purposes. Same-root data can never satisfy an independent two-source requirement.

Article 4 — No Authorization, No Contact. A rights or authority failure denies acquisition before any contact with the source occurs. The check precedes the network call; it is not a post-hoc audit.

Article 5 — Raw Before Transform. The raw artifact must be preserved before any transformation runs. A parsed representation that outlives its raw original is invalid evidence.

Article 6 — Immutable After Finalization. A finalized evidence version is never updated. Correction produces a new version with explicit lineage to the old.

Article 22 — Evidence Version Is Immutable. Every derivative is a new version. Restated separately from Article 6 because Article 6 governs the original and Article 22 governs the derivative chain.

Group B — Epistemic discipline

Article 28 — No Unsupported Independence. Independence is derived from lineage, never asserted. An unproven dependency relation is `UNKNOWN`, and `UNKNOWN` is not `INDEPENDENT`.

Article 29 — No Unqualified Absence. Absence may only be reported as `OBSERVED_ABSENT` after the observability gate passes. Otherwise it is `EXPECTED_BUT_NOT_TESTED`, `NOT_OBSERVABLE`, `NOT_COLLECTABLE`, `PARTIAL_COVERAGE`, `SOURCE_UNAVAILABLE`, or `INCONCLUSIVE`.

Article 30 — No Absolute Epistemic Claims. Integrity, provenance, qualification, procedural neutrality, and legal determination are five distinct claims. Collapsing any two is a violation.

Article 11 — Disagreement Must Remain Visible. Dissent is never deleted, downgraded, or silently resolved. Material unresolved dissent must appear in the final finding.

Group C — AI authority

Article 8 — AI Has No Evidence Authority. No AI system may create, alter, qualify, or sign authoritative evidence. AI proposes; the evidence fabric disposes.

Article 27 — No Silent AI Influence. Material AI contribution is recorded — model, version, prompt hash, input evidence versions, policy version, output hash, human reviewer. Influence without a contribution record is a violation.

Article 21 — Redaction Does Not Imply AI Eligibility. A redacted derivative is not automatically AI-processable. It must independently pass AI processing policy.

Group D — Access and disclosure

Article 20 — Access Does Not Imply Use. `VIEW` $\neq$ `SEARCH` $\neq$ `COPY` $\neq$ `PRINT` $\neq$ `DOWNLOAD` $\neq$ `EXPORT` $\neq$ `REDISTRIBUTE` $\neq$ `AI_PROCESS` $\neq$ `RAG` $\neq$ `TRAIN`. Each is separately granted.

Article 24 — No Silent Disclosure. Every disclosure is an event on the canonical ledger. There is no disclosure path that does not emit one.

Article 19 — Privilege Is Authority-Determined. VERIQO enforces a privilege decision made by an authorized legal authority. It never makes the substantive determination itself.

Article 25 — No Silent Privilege Change. A privilege status transition is an immutable event.

Group E — Redaction

Article 17 — No Destructive Redaction. The original is never modified. Redaction produces a derivative.

Article 18 — No Visual-Only Redaction. A black rectangle drawn over text is not redaction. The content must be absent from the derivative's bytes, metadata, and recoverable layers.

Group F — Procedure and neutrality

Article 12 — Procedural Symmetry. Parties are treated under the same policy unless an authorized, recorded exception exists.

Article 13 — Party Influence Must Be Disclosed. Which party requested what evidence, what scope, what source, what was rejected — all recorded as process evidence.

Article 14 — Conflict Must Be Declared. Conflicts of interest for people, reviewers, providers, models, vendors, and data dependencies are declared, never concealed.

Article 15 — No Outcome-Contingent Neutrality. VERIQO may not benefit differentially from the outcome of a dispute it provides evidence for.

Article 16 — No Adjudication by Platform. VERIQO does not determine legal liability. A qualification is not a verdict.

Group G — Policy and time

Article 7 — Historical Policy Pinning. A historical case is evaluated under the policy version in force at the time, not today's.

Article 26 — No Silent Policy Retroactivity. A policy change is never quietly applied to an already-computed historical result.

Group H — Verification

Article 10 — Replay Must Be Independent. Replay must be verifiable without trusting the primary runtime.

Article 23 — Audit Is Evidence. Process evidence — how the evidence was obtained, decided, and disclosed — is itself evidence, and is governed by the same constitution.

Article 9 — ZKP Has Bounded Meaning. A zero-knowledge proof establishes exactly the predicate it was constructed for. It does not establish the truth of the underlying world, liability, causation, legal validity, or admissibility.

2. Article dependency

Some articles subsume others; violating the deeper one violates both.

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Article 2 (No Truth by Acquisition)
└─ Article 3 (No Corroboration by Duplication)
    └─ Article 28 (No Unsupported Independence)

Article 30 (No Absolute Epistemic Claims)
└─ Article 16 (No Adjudication by Platform)
    └─ Article 29 (No Unqualified Absence)

Article 8 (AI Has No Evidence Authority)
└─ Article 27 (No Silent AI Influence)
    └─ Article 21 (Redaction ≠ AI Eligibility)

Article 6 (Immutable After Finalization)
└─ Article 22 (Evidence Version Is Immutable)
    └─ Article 17 (No Destructive Redaction)
```

A checker reporting Article 3 satisfied while Article 28 is violated is itself defective — `pkg/constitution` enforces this consistency.

3. Enforcement classes

Not every article is enforceable by the same mechanism. Stating which is which prevents the illusion that a document check equals a runtime guarantee.

Class	Meaning	Articles
STRUCTURAL	The type system or state machine makes violation unrepresentable.	6, 17, 22

Class	Meaning	Articles
CHECKED	A runtime check refuses the operation.	1, 3, 4, 5, 8, 19, 20, 24, 25, 28, 29
RECORDED	Violation is not preventable, but is always detectable after the fact from the ledger.	11, 12, 13, 14, 23, 26, 27
DECLARED	An organizational commitment the software surfaces but cannot enforce alone.	15, 16, 30
BOUNDED	Enforced by construction of the mechanism's own semantics.	9, 10, 21
PINNED	Enforced by version binding.	7

DECLARED is the honest class. Article 15 (no outcome-contingent neutrality) cannot be enforced by code — it is a commercial arrangement. `pkg/constitution` marks these as **DECLARED** and reports them as requiring external attestation rather than pretending a unit test settles them.

4. Relationship to the existing invariant set

An earlier round produced INV-001..INV-010 in the Trust Authority Model. Those remain in force. This constitution is broader (governance, disclosure, AI, procedure) and does not supersede them; where they overlap, the stricter reading governs. `pkg/constitution` documents the mapping per-article.

5. Amendment

Articles are frozen. An amendment requires a new numbered article, a recorded rationale, and a version bump on the constitution document hash — never an edit in place. This document's own governance follows Article 6.